In light of all of the above, Israel adopted as part of its security doctrine the strategy of prevention, the reasoning behind which is to block the adversary from building up his power over time and to prevent him from bringing his capabilities to fruition. Sometimes aggressive retaliation is fully successful, as in the case of the direct hit on the Iraqi nuclear reactor Osirak, which resulted in the destruction of the reactor's core beyond reparation. The Iraqis, who had sought to achieve military nuclearization via plutonium enrichment, changed tracks to enriching uranium in centrifuges in the wake of the destruction of the reactor. Prevention can be achieved via sabotage that is either "loud" or "quiet," and without the adversary even being aware that he has been thwarted. Even if there is such a suspicion, the enemy may not be able to assert with full confidence that his efforts have been foiled. In the cyber age, preventive capabilities have become all the more sophisticated, and on this subject silence is golden.

It should be emphasized that the doctrine of prevention focuses, as a general rule, on nonconventional strategic weapons and not on conventional weapons. When it comes to conventional weapons, prevention is not worthwhile, even when it is possible. For example, the sabotage of one aircraft of an entire squadron that an enemy state has bought or received from a superpower does not pass the cost-benefit test, because the risks involved (the exposure of capabilities and intelligence sources, for example) are very large.

Back to the years 1987 to 1989. The Mossad, which had placed the Iraqi threat at the top of its list of priorities on the EEI, used all the tools and capabilities at its disposal, either directly or indirectly. Its direct capabilities included HUMINT, SIGINT, and all types of special operations. There was a body established within the intelligence community called Idan Hadash ("A New Era"). It was chaired by the head of the Mossad or his deputy, and its members were senior representatives from the Mossad, Military Intelligence, and the scientific community, all intelligence and prevention experts. The forum convened frequently, at the initiative of the Mossad director's bureau, though any member of the forum was entitled to call for a discussion if any developments took place that he or she thought justified the convening of the forum. The forum discussed the intelligence products that had been added since the previous meeting, reassessed the updated intelligence picture and the significance of the threat, steered the